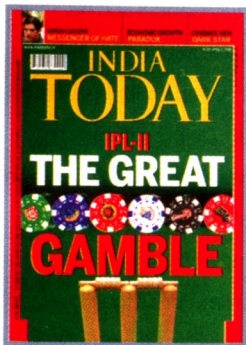


IPL-II: The Great Gamble

APRIL 6, 2009

After a wildly successful start, Indian Premier League Season II is embroiled in election-related politics which forces it to move to South Africa and raises questions about financial viability and logistical challenges.



“The decision to shift IPL-II is the product of a collective failure. But why bring in politics? Cricket's politicisation will not only dampen the spirits of players but also ruin the game.”

J. AKSHAY, via www.indiatoday.in

Hard Pitch

The IPL-II is already turning out to be a political potboiler. The clash of political egos compelled the mega cricketing event to be shifted out of India, elections and security risk notwithstanding. The excitement is not merely about watching the matches live on television, but in seeing and hearing anxious spectators who throng the venue, adding an interesting flavour to the extravaganza. Will IPL-II succeed on this front?

ANJUM M. SAMEL,
Mumbai

The shifting of the IPL tournament to South Africa is indeed bad news for cricket lovers in India. The security reason sounds plausible, but it was the stalemate between the BCCI and the



Poll Manoeuvres

Politics is all about managing one's vote bank, and soliciting votes on communal grounds is an old trick ("Messiah of Hate", March 30). It pays to keep the voters happy. Varun Gandhi's arrest was nothing but a subtle way of appeasing the minorities. But his imprisonment may just backfire and fetch rich electoral dividends for the BJP in Uttar Pradesh.

DANENDRA JAIN, via www.indiatoday.in

The BJP should ideally abstain from giving undeserved prominence to a hate-spewing leader like Varun Gandhi and withdraw his candidature from Pilibhit to prove its secular credentials.

AKSHAY DADHWAL SUNHET, Kangra

Home Ministry which was behind this decision. It is another blow to our tourism industry.

VIRENDRA KUMAR TANGRI,
via www.indiatoday.in

Tough Times Ahead

President Asif Zardari's rise to power was purely accidental ("Sharif Power", March 30). He went on to occupy a position he never deserved. It took no time for him to show his true colours. In comparison, Nawaz Sharif smartly exploited the opportunity given to him by Zardari. The result: Zardari is isolated, the Pakistan Peoples Party stands divided and Sharif is more popular than ever before.

R.J. KHURANA,
Bhopal

It remains to be seen if Nawaz Sharif emerges as

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